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- Security Management
- Control overall system performance
- Error detecting aids
- Coordination between other software and users

The most popular Operating System are as follows:

- Windows Series - for desktop and laptop computers.
- Android - for smart phones.
- iOS - for Apple phones, i-Pad and i-Pod.
- Linux - Open source Operating System for desktop and server.

5.2. Introduction to Windows Operating System

Every computer needs an Operating System to function. Microsoft Windows is one of the most popular Graphical User Interface (GUI). Multiple applications can execute simultaneously in Windows, and this is known as **"Multitasking".**

Windows Operating System uses both Keyboard and mouse as input devices. Mouse is used to interact with Windows by clicking its icons. Keyboard is used to enter alphabets, numerals and special characters.

Some of the functions of Windows Operating System are:

- Access applications (programs) on the computer (word processing, games, spread sheets, calculators and so on).
- Load any new program on the computer.
- Manage hardware such as printers, scanners, mouse, digital cameras etc.,
- File management activities (For example creating, modifying, saving, deleting files and folders).
- Change computer settings such as colour scheme, screen savers of your monitor, etc.

With reference to the Table 5.1, let us see the versions of Windows Operating System.

5.3. Various versions of Windows

Versions	Logo	Year	Specific features
Windows 1.x	MICROSOFT WINDOWS	1985	• Introduction of GUI in 16 - bit. processor • Mouse was introduced as an input device.
Windows 2.x	MICROSOFT WINDOWS	1987	• Supports to minimize or maximize windows. • Control panel feature was introduced with various system settings and customising options.
Windows 3.x	MICROSOFT WINDOWS	1992	• Introduced the concept of multitasking. • Supported 256 colours which brought a more modern, colourful look to the interface.